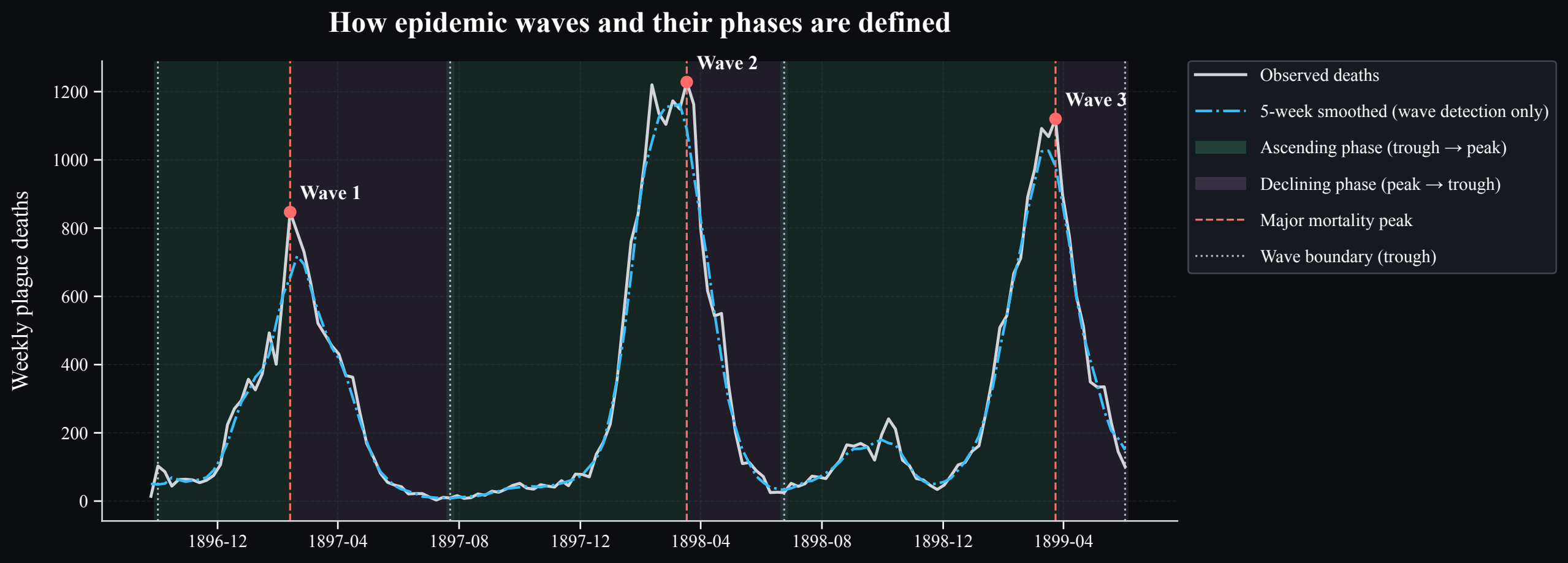
How epidemic waves and their phases are defined
Weekly plague deaths
0
200
400
600
800
1000
1200
1896-12
1897-04
1897-08
1897-12
1898-04
1898-08
1898-12
1899-04
Wave 1
Wave 2
Wave 3
Observed deaths
5-week smoothed (wave detection only)
Ascending phase (trough → peak)
Declining phase (peak → trough)
Major mortality peak
Wave boundary (trough)